

Dr. Rainer Widmann

Data Scientist

Profile

Data Scientist focused on experimentation and interpretable models of customer behavior. Experienced in pricing, customer retention, supplier evaluation, and operational analytics, with a background in causal inference and applied econometrics.

Personal

Nationality: Austrian
Address: Salzburg, Austria
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Languages

English, fluent
German, native

Interests

Quality Analytics
Supplier Management
Experimentation
Customer Behavior
Decision Science

@ Website

 LinkedIn Profile

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

06/2026–

Red Bull

DATA SCIENTIST · Salzburg, Austria 📍

- Data Scientist supporting analytical initiatives related to product quality and supplier management.



09/2024–05/2026

Zooplus (E-commerce)

DATA SCIENTIST · Munich, Germany 📍

- Developed structural retention models to quantify how delivery performance and product availability influence customer repurchase behavior and long-term customer value.
- Designed and analyzed pricing interventions to evaluate the relative effectiveness of overfiller promotions and comparable price reductions on sales uplift in an e-commerce setting.
- Developed a causal supplier benchmarking framework leveraging operational batch switches in logistics centers to connect supplier-specific product experience to repeat-purchase behavior and infer supplier-specific product quality.
- Conducted power simulations and validation analyses for pet food palatability studies involving repeated-measures feeding experiments and multi-product choice settings.



08/2018–08/2024

Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition

ECONOMIC RESEARCHER (DATA SCIENCE FOCUS) · Munich, Germany 📍

- Analyzed large-scale platform and behavioral data to quantify the effect of competition on individual performance of coders using causal modeling techniques.
- Built NLP pipelines on patent text data to extract, structure, and analyze innovation signals across countries and industries.
- Presented and defended analytical results to diverse audiences, translating complex empirical findings into clear narratives for economists, policymakers, and interdisciplinary collaborators.



DEGREES

- 2018 **Ph.D. Managerial Economics and Strategy**
NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY · United States 
- 2012 **M.Sc. Economics**
TU VIENNA · Austria 
- 2010 **B.A. Political Science**
UNIVERSITY OF VIENNA · Austria 

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Motives, Gender, and Experience: Performance Effects in Crowdsourcing Contests. *Strategy Science* 

Sexual Misconduct, Accused Scientists, and Their Research. *Review of Economics and Statistics* 

The Behavioral Additionality of Government Research Grants. *International Journal of Industrial Organization* 

SKILLS

Programming & Data: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels, Polars), SQL, PySpark, Git, DVC

Modeling & Experimentation: Predictive modeling (regression, classification, tree-based models), A/B testing, experiment design, power analysis

Causal & Advanced Analytics: Quasi-experimental methods, causal ML, applied econometrics

Business Applications: Pricing & assortment, customer retention & loyalty, product experience analysis, logistics analysis

Visualization & Communication: Power BI, Tableau, Python/R visualizations (Matplotlib, ggplot2)